

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

Madam Rides the Bus

First Flight - prose | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

How does Valli plan and save for her bus journey?

Answer:

She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Her planning shows independence and determination.

Question 2

What does Valli's reaction to the dead cow reveal about her?

Answer:

On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. This change reveals a child's growing awareness of loss and life's vulnerability.

Question 3

Why does Valli refuse help from the conductor and other passengers?

Answer:

She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. Her proud independence is charming, though the story also shows that she is still young and inexperienced.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

The central focus is: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

First point: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Second point: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in Madam Rides the Bus lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Then connect it to the result: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death.

Madam Rides the Bus - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Her planning shows independence and determination. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. This change reveals a child's growing awareness of loss and life's vulnerability. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

The first idea is: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. The second idea is: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Effect or outcome: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Next, On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. Finally, She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child.

Madam Rides the Bus - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Add one supporting point: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. End with the outcome or message: She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

A sound inference is that she wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Then justify the response with: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death.

Question 18

What would make an answer from Madam Rides the Bus incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Also add: She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child.

Madam Rides the Bus - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

Assertion: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Reason: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from Madam Rides the Bus in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

Use three connected points: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. - and close with: She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in Madam Rides the Bus be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death.

Question 24

Which detail from Madam Rides the Bus is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

Madam Rides the Bus - Continued

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

1. She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. 2. On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. 3. She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from Madam Rides the Bus before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death.

Question 28

Why does Madam Rides the Bus remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from Madam Rides the Bus.

Answer:

Opening: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. Development: On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death. Conclusion: She wants to be treated as a capable passenger, not as a little child. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about Madam Rides the Bus?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: She carefully observes the bus service, learns the fare and travel time, and saves every coin by resisting small treats. and On the outward journey she laughs at the lively cow, but on the return she is saddened by its death.

Sources: CBSE English curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.